

Cybersecurity Fundamentals for Students

Essential security practices for university life

What Is Cybersecurity?

- Cybersecurity protects devices, networks, and data from unauthorized access
- Students are frequent targets because they handle personal and academic information
- A breach can lead to identity theft, financial loss, and academic disruption
- Good habits reduce risk for yourself and your campus community



Common Cyber Threats

- Malware: malicious software that damages or steals data
- Viruses: self-replicating code that spreads via infected files
- Phishing: deceptive emails or messages that trick you into revealing credentials
- Social engineering: manipulation tactics that exploit human trust

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Password Security & Authentication

- Use unique, complex passwords of at least 12 characters
- Enable multi-factor authentication (MFA) wherever available
- Store passwords in a reputable password manager
- Never reuse passwords across multiple accounts

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Safe Browsing & Email Security

CYBERSECURITY FUNDAMENTALS FOR STUDENTS

- Check for HTTPS and a padlock icon before entering sensitive data
- Hover over links to verify the true destination before clicking
- Treat unexpected attachments or urgent requests with suspicion
- Report phishing attempts to your campus IT security team

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Think before you click; verify sources before sharing information.

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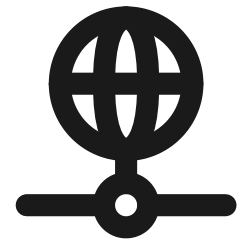
Data Privacy & Protection

- Limit personal data shared on social media and public profiles
- Adjust privacy settings on apps and online services regularly
- Encrypt sensitive files on your laptop and phone
- Understand your rights under data protection regulations (e.g., GDPR, FERPA)



Network Security Basics

- Avoid using public Wi-Fi for banking or academic portals without a VPN
- Use a trusted virtual private network (VPN) on untrusted networks
- Enable firewall protection on your devices
- Disable automatic connection to open Wi-Fi networks



Thank You

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